

Progressive Education Society's Modern College of Engineering, Pune - 05

(An Autonomous Institute Affiliated to Savitribai Phule Pune University)

SDV05601 – SKILL DEVELOPMENT - I

(Second year MCA Sem. I)



Week-11

Activity 11 – Participate in a group discussion: “AI is replacing human jobs – agree or disagree”.

WEEK 11: ACTIVITY 11 – GROUP DISCUSSION

CO609.4: : Participate in collaborative tasks and discussions to build teamwork, etiquette, and problem-solving abilities.

Activity description: Students will participate in a group discussion: “AI is replacing human jobs – agree or disagree?”.



GROUP DISCUSSION - INTRODUCTION

Group Discussion (GD) is a structured conversation where participants share ideas, opinions, and arguments on a given topic within a set time. It is commonly used in academic, professional, and recruitment settings to assess candidates on communication skills, teamwork, leadership, problem-solving, and knowledge of current issues.

PURPOSE OF A GROUP DISCUSSION

- **Assess** communication skills.
- **Evaluate** teamwork and leadership abilities.
- **Judge** logical thinking and clarity of thought.
- **Observe** confidence and attitude.
- **Measure** awareness of current affairs or specific domain knowledge.

KEY ELEMENTS OF A GROUP DISCUSSION

- Topic
- Participants
- Time Limit
- Moderator/Judge



SKILLS TESTED

- Verbal Communication
- Active Listening
- Logical Reasoning
- Problem-solving
- Leadership and Initiative
- Interpersonal Skills



TIPS TO PERFORM WELL IN A GROUP DISCUSSION

- Stay updated with current affairs.
- Structure your thoughts before speaking.
- Initiate the discussion if you can confidently set the direction.
- Speak clearly and to the point.
- Respect others' opinions.
- Encourage quieter participants.
- Avoid dominating the discussion.



BENEFITS OF A GROUP DISCUSSION

1) Improved communication skills:

- Articulation and expression
- Active listening

2) Enhanced critical thinking and problem solving:

- Diverse perspectives
- Quick thinking

3) Development of leadership qualities:

- Initiative taking
- Conflict resolution



BENEFITS OF A GROUP DISCUSSION

4) Teamwork and collaborative learning:

- Shared learning experience
- Building confidence

5) Exposure to different viewpoints:

- Broadening horizons
- Cultural competence

6) Better preparation for real world scenarios:

- Simulated real-life interactions
- Feedback mechanism



BENEFITS OF A GROUP DISCUSSION

7) Enhanced academic and professional profile:

- Interview and assessment advantage
- Networking

In summary, group discussions not only foster improved communication and critical thinking skills but also cultivate leadership, teamwork, and cultural awareness. These benefits make them an essential tool in both educational and professional development, ultimately aiding participants in becoming more effective communicators and well-rounded individuals.

STEPS TO CONDUCT OR PARTICIPATE IN A GROUP DISCUSSION

1) Selection of the Topic:

- Topics can be factual, current affairs, abstract, or case-based.
- The topic may be given in advance or on the spot.

STEPS TO CONDUCT OR PARTICIPATE IN A GROUP DISCUSSION

2) Preparation Time (2–5 minutes):

- Use this time to quickly organize your thoughts.
- Jot down key points, examples, and a logical structure.
- Decide if you will initiate, support, or counter a point.

STEPS TO CONDUCT OR PARTICIPATE IN A GROUP DISCUSSION

3) Initiation of the Discussion:

A confident participant can start the discussion by:

- Briefly explaining the topic
- Giving a neutral opening to invite others
- Laying out both sides of the argument (if controversial)

Initiating helps you score well, but only if done confidently and clearly.

STEPS TO CONDUCT OR PARTICIPATE IN A GROUP DISCUSSION

4) Participation in the Discussion:

- Speak with clarity, logic, and respect.
- Listen carefully and respond to others' points (not just your own).
- Maintain a balanced approach: Don't dominate, don't stay silent.
- Use examples, data, or short stories to support your point.
- Encourage others or bring quieter members into the conversation.

STEPS TO CONDUCT OR PARTICIPATE IN A GROUP DISCUSSION

5. Summarization

Anyone can summarize if the moderator doesn't assign it.

A good summary includes:

- Key points discussed.
- Consensus (if any).
- A balanced conclusion (if the group reached one).

Avoid giving your own opinion in the summary unless asked.

DOS AND DON'TS IN A GROUP DISCUSSION

Dos:

- 1) Speak clearly and confidently.
- 2) Respect other views.
- 3) Use facts and examples.
- 4) Maintain eye contact.
- 5) Be calm and composed.
- 6) Take notes if helpful.



DOS AND DON'TS IN A GROUP DISCUSSION

Don'ts:

- 1) Interrupt others.
- 2) Shout or argue aggressively.
- 3) Go off-topic.
- 4) Only focus on the moderator.
- 5) Criticize personally.
- 6) Repeat points already made.



